Tereza Blazkova
PhD Student in Social Data Science, University of Copenhagen
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Research Interests

I study how predictive systems are designed and evaluated, including how the people they concern can have a say in their design and whether the models work equally well for different groups. Most of my work is in education and spans **stakeholder participation in AI design** (deliberative workshops in which students and counsellors set the rules for selecting a dropout prediction model), **LLM agents as synthetic stakeholders** (open-weight LLM panels that replicate the same deliberation, evaluated against the human panel), and **fairness auditing** (audits of models built on nationwide administrative registry data). I combine machine learning, statistics and mixed methods to evaluate these systems and identify how they could be improved

Education

PhD in Social Data Science in progress
University of Copenhagen
– Supervisors: Andreas Bjerre-Nielsen (University of Copenhagen) and René F. Kizilcec (Cornell University)
– Main focus: predictive modeling, algorithmic fairness and education; combining mixed methods with algorithm audits for participatory algorithm design

MSc in Social Data Science
University of Copenhagen
– Thesis: *Using Machine Learning to Predict University Dropout: A Study on Accuracy and Fairness* (grade 12/12)

BA in Sociology with Economics
Charles University, Prague
– Graduated with honours

Awards

2026	**Prize winner (top 3), Tutoring Outcomes Competition**, *National Tutoring Observatory*
2026	**Fulbright Schuman Scholarship**, *doctoral research grant, academic year 2026/2027*
2026	**Academic Guest House Residency**, *Bikuben Foundation, New York*
BA studies	**Scholarship for excellent academic results**, *Charles University*

Research Positions

Visiting PhD Student Sep 2026 – present
Hosted by Allison Koenecke, KLEAR Lab, Cornell Tech, New York, NY
– Research on participatory model selection

Visiting PhD Student Jan 2025; Jan 2026
Hosted by René F. Kizilcec, Future of Learning Lab, Cornell University, Ithaca, NY
– Research on fairness over time in dropout prediction and on the learning pathways of students with disabilities

Guest Researcher 2023 – present
Statistics Denmark
– Build machine learning and fairness-auditing pipelines on nationwide administrative registry data in Statistics Denmark's secure research environment

Secondee, EU NeEDS (Network of European Data Scientists) June 2024
University of Seville; Marie Skłodowska-Curie programme

Research Assistant 2023 – 2024
Center for Social Data Science, University of Copenhagen

Research Assistant 2022 – 2024
Sustainability Centre, Copenhagen Business School

Publications

Under review

– **Participatory Model Selection: Turning Stakeholder Deliberation into Constraints for Student Dropout Prediction**
Blazkova, T., Kizilcec, R. F., Bjerre-Nielsen, A., Koenecke, A.
Under review at the ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT)

Working papers

– **The Importance of Student Signal in Predicting Tutoring Outcomes**
Blazkova, T., Boucherie, L.
Based on a prize-winning entry to the National Tutoring Observatory Tutoring Outcomes Competition

Published

- **Queering the Audits: Community-Based Auditing of AI Harms to Queer Communities**
  Organizers of Queer in AI, Pranav, A., Valentine, A. A., Markham, A., LeClair, B., **Blazkova, T.**, Kornilitsina, E., Bruun, S. H., Spanakis, G., Lauscher, A.
  Identity-Aware AI Workshop (IAAI) @ LREC 2026
- **Fairness Over Time: A Nationwide Study of Evolving Bias in Dropout Prediction**
  Blazkova, T., Kizilcec, R. F., Nielsen, M. L., Lassen, D. D., Bjerre-Nielsen, A.
  Proceedings of the Twelfth ACM Conference on Learning @ Scale (L@S '25), 2025
- **Sentiments and Sustainability: Stakeholder Perceptions of Sustainable Fashion on Social Media**
  Blazkova, T., Pedersen, E. R. G., Andersen, K. R.
  Journal of Fashion Marketing and Management, 2025
- **Greenwashing Debates on Twitter: Stakeholders and Critical Topics**
  Blazkova, T., Pedersen, E. R. G., Andersen, K. R., Rosati, F.
  Journal of Cleaner Production, 2023, 139260

Talks and Presentations

2026	**Synthetic Stakeholders? Agreement and Stability of Open-Weight LLM Agent Panels in Participatory Model Selection**, *poster, Agent Evaluation Science 2026, New York*
2026	**Modeling Student Academic Trajectories**, *Professional Academic Advising Community (PAAC) Conference*
2025	**The Role of Outcome Imbalance in Fairness Over Time**, *poster, Unifying Perspectives on Learning Biases Workshop, EurIPS, Copenhagen*
2025	**Using National Registries for Predicting Educational Outcomes**, *Charles University (Sociologické zahraničení), Prague*
2025	**Participatory AI Design for Dropout Prevention Algorithms**, *Learning Analytics in Practice (LAP25), online*
2025	**Variations in Learning Pathways Among Students with Disabilities and Algorithmic Fairness**, *Future of Learning Lab, Cornell University*
2025	**Using National Registries for Predicting Educational Outcomes**, *Czexpats in Science, Embassy of the Czech Republic, Copenhagen*
2024	**Predicting University Dropout: A Study on Accuracy and Fairness**, *European Centre for Algorithmic Transparency, Seville*

Teaching and Supervision

2025–26	**Thesis Supervisor**, *supervised 5 graduate theses and 2 industrial internships*
2025	**Teaching Assistant, Digital Methods**, *weekly exercise classes, graduate course on digital mixed methods*
2025	**Guest Lecturer, Data Governance**, *lecture: Predictive Analytics and Its Ethical and Political Implications*
2023	**Teaching Assistant, Data Governance**, *weekly exercise classes on legal, political and ethical aspects of data governance; guided 16 student projects*

Service and Leadership

2026	**Reviewer**, *AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence, AI for Social Impact track; AES Symposium on Agent Evaluation Science*
2025	**PhD Student Representative**, *Center for Social Data Science, University of Copenhagen*
2022–24	**Graduate Study Board Representative**, *Center for Social Data Science; helped introduce conditional use of LLM tools in take-home exams*
2022–24	**Co-founder, Social Data Science Student Subject Council**, *organised the first Regional Social Data Science Student Conference (four universities)*

Skills

Methods	Large-scale registry data analysis, machine learning, fairness auditing, causal inference (regression discontinuity), experimental design (vignette and conjoint surveys), deliberative workshops and participatory design, NLP
Toolkits	Python (pandas, scikit-learn, PyTorch, statsmodels, SHAP..); R (tidyverse, ggplot2); LaTeX
AI tools	Open-weight LLMs (e.g., Llama, Qwen) run via Hugging Face/vLLM for multi-agent stakeholder simulations; Claude Code for building analysis pipelines and prototyping research ideas